

Large square collar continues from the front and emphasizes the shoulder width

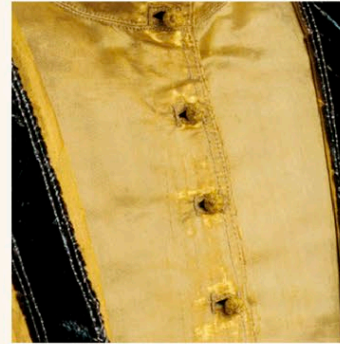
Back of high collar is cut in one piece with the back of the doublet



Hanging sleeves are largely decorative, with armholes halfway down

Coat is nearly a full circle with the width pleated into the shoulders

IN DETAIL



◁ KNOTTED SILK BUTTONS

The buttons closing the front of the doublet are made by wrapping a wooden core with a herringbone pattern of silk thread. The shank is very long to raise the decorative part above the strain of the buttonholes, which are stitched in silk thread.



◁ SILK DAMASK

The stunning yellow silk is damask-woven: this means the massive, rounded pomegranate pattern is made by contrasting the matt and sheen of two directions of weaving that catch the light differently. It was more expensive than a plain weave.



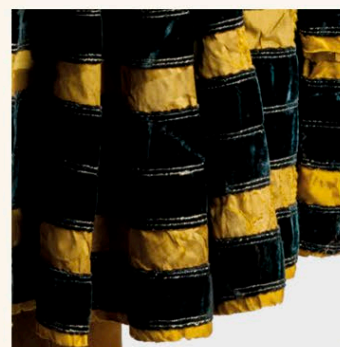
◁ PUFFED SHOULDERS

By alternating straight strips of black velvet with the damask to form puffs, the shoulders are made bigger. Increasing the volume across the torso was popular in the early 16th century. It added bulk and an imposing presence. Laces on the inside hold up the puffs.



◁ PASSEMENTERIE KNOTS

On the end of the hanging sleeves are cross shapes of Italian passementerie – cord, knot, and tassel work made from silk. The vegetable-dyed colours have faded from the original violet. The pale parts of the knots are entwined with silver-gilt thread to catch the light.



◁ EVEN FOLDS

The elegant hang of the coat is created by deep pleats. In German regions at this time, both men's and women's clothing used huge quantities of round, even pleats. The contrasting colour bands form an arresting horizontal against the strong vertical lines.